

# ARCHANGEL

## The Avenging Angel



Warren's skin gained a blue pigment during his time working for Apocalypse.

Warren Worthington was born into a wealthy family. At private school, during his late teens, Warren noticed wings budding from his shoulder blades. Fearful of attracting attention, he strapped them to his body but secretly began experimenting with flying. When a fire started in his school, Warren flew to the rescue of his schoolmates disguised in a nightshirt and blond wig. He was mistaken

for an angel and so, when he headed to New York City to become a costumed crime fighter, he took the moniker Avenging Angel.

### ITINERANT X-MAN

Warren soon came to the attention of PROFESSOR X and joined the Professor's fledgling band of X-MEN. At first, Warren disguised his face with a mask, but he later discarded it, believing that his handsome, telegenic features would help gain the team public support. With his vast, inherited wealth it was perhaps inevitable that he would become a media playboy. Similarly, although he remained loyal to Professor X's broad ideals, he drifted between various superpowered teams, using his fortune to provide



Having lost both his parents, the X-Men have become a surrogate family to Archangel, bickering and fighting but also protecting and defending each other.

backing to the Champions of Los Angeles, the DEFENDERS and later X-FACTOR. While with X-Factor Warren's wings were damaged battling the MARAUDERS. The wings became infected and had to be amputated. The loss of his wings so depressed Warren that he attempted suicide. Saved by the mutant warlord APOCALYPSE, Warren was offered the chance to grow new wings of steel if he became one of Apocalypse's Horsemen—Death. Confused and still depressed, Warren agreed, but this Faustian pact brought him into direct conflict with his X-Men friends. Only the apparent death of his old friend Iceman brought Warren to his senses. Following this epiphany, Warren's metal wings molted to reveal feathers

### ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **X-Men Vol. 1 #54-6** Warren Worthington's origins are shown—from a public schoolboy who grows wings to a member of the X-Men.
- **X-Factor #10-15, Thor #373-4** Angel's wings are amputated and he is driven to suicide.
- **X-Factor #21-25** Apocalypse appoints Angel as his Fourth Horseman, Death.

When his wings are pinned to his body, Warren can pass as a non-mutant.



### FACTFILE

#### REAL NAME

Warren Kenneth Worthington III

#### OCCUPATION

Hero and Chairman of Worthington Industries

#### BASE

New York State ("Avengers Tower"), Manhattan, New York

#### HEIGHT

6 ft

#### WEIGHT

150 lbs

#### EYES

Blue

#### HAIR

Blond

#### FIRST APPEARANCE

X-Men #1 (September 1963)

Feathered wings can carry up to twice his weight and bear him to 29,000 feet; able to fly up to 150 mph; enhanced lungs enable him to breathe at high altitudes; possesses extraordinary eyesight and blood has healing qualities.



During his recent stay in Genosha as part of the Excalibur team, Archangel battled the high-tech soldiers known as the Weaponers.

beneath. Returning to the X-Men, Warren rechristened himself Archangel. Later, Warren's metal wings molted to reveal the original, feathered ones regrown beneath. When his skin returned to its normal color, he went back to calling himself Angel for a while.

Recently, WOLFSBANE tore off Warren's wings again and gave them to the anti-mutant Purifiers, who distilled an Apocalypse Strain from them and used it to give many of their agents metallic wings. Warren soon transformed back into Archangel once again. He can now morph back and forth between his Angel and Archangel personas at will. **AD, MF**